



JAPANESE

ANCIENT MEETS MODERN

JAPAN IS MADE UP OF FOUR MAIN volcanic islands and over 3,900 smaller islands situated to the east of mainland Asia. Nearly 75 percent of the country is rugged and mountainous and virtually uninhabitable, and the

The modern city

Tokyo, the capital of Japan, is a fast-paced, energetic city that never seems to rest. It houses a population of 12 million people and covers approximately 800 sq miles (2,100 sq km). Much of the capital was destroyed in World War II and today is filled with high-rise office buildings and sprawling suburbs.



HOT SPRINGS

The islands that make up Japan are volcanic, and like a giant sponge, Japan leaks from thousands of hot springs, or *onsen*. For over 2,000 years the Japanese have enjoyed hot, outdoor baths in the naturally warm waters.

A MODERN WORLD

Japanese children and teenagers are very much a modern generation, listening to Western pop music and keeping up with fashions.

Rush hour
in Tokyo.



ROBOT TECHNOLOGY

Few people in the modern world are unaffected by the technological ideas of Japan, from cars to computers. High-tech toys and games have been at the forefront of Japanese technology since the 1970s. Today about half of the world's robots are found in Japan.

